

NORTH INDIAN RESTAURANT TRADITION

Garlic Naan

Tandoor Bread with Garlic & Coriander
A Modern Restaurant Favorite

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Garlic Naan

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Garlic Naan

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Restaurant-Era Naan

Unlike plain and butter naan, which trace back through Mughal court cuisine and Punjab's dhaba culture, garlic naan is a newer arrival — most food historians place its rise in the mid-to-late 20th century, as North Indian restaurants both within India and across the diaspora looked for ways to differentiate their tandoor bread offerings.

The idea is straightforward but effective: press minced garlic and chopped coriander onto the rolled dough before it goes into the tandoor, so the garlic roasts and slightly chars in the intense heat, turning sweet and nutty rather than sharp. The result became so popular that garlic naan is now often the single best-selling bread on North Indian restaurant menus worldwide, arguably more recognized abroad than in many traditional Indian households.

Whether or not it has centuries of history behind it, garlic naan has earned its place — the combination of pillowy tandoor bread, roasted garlic, and fresh herbs is one of those pairings that simply works, which is why it has become a permanent fixture of North Indian dining everywhere from Delhi to London to Los Angeles.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Restaurant-Era Naan, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A staple of North Indian restaurant menus worldwide, often the most-ordered bread alongside butter naan. Considered a more contemporary addition to the naan family, popularized through restaurant kitchens rather than home cooking or royal courts. A favorite pairing with rich, creamy curries, where the garlic cuts through the richness of the gravy.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

20m	1.5h	20m	6
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH RISE	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (6 NAANS)

Med
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Large mixing bowl
- Rolling pin
- Heavy cast-iron tava, skillet, or a pizza stone/steel in the oven
- Small bowl for the garlic-coriander topping
- Basting brush

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough can be refrigerated after its first rise for up to a day. Mince the garlic and coriander fresh just before cooking for the best aroma — pre-chopped garlic loses its punch quickly. Cooked garlic naan keeps refrigerated for 2 days; reheat on a hot tava rather than a microwave to keep the topping from turning soggy.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
All-purpose flour (maida)	3 cups	375 g	3 katori
Instant yeast	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Plain yogurt	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Milk, lukewarm	½ cup	120 ml	½ katori
Water, lukewarm	¼ cup	60 ml	¼ katori
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste

For the garlic topping

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Garlic, finely minced	6–8 cloves	25 g	6–8 cloves
Fresh coriander, finely chopped	3 tbsp	12 g	3 tbsp
Butter or ghee, melted	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Red chili flakes — optional	½ tsp	1 g	½ chammach

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Fresh garlic is essential here — jarred pre-minced garlic tends to burn bitter under high heat and lacks the same sweetness when roasted. If coriander (cilantro) isn't to your taste, finely chopped parsley is a reasonable, if less traditional, substitute. For a milder garlic flavor, lightly sauté the minced garlic in butter for 30 seconds before topping the naan, rather than applying it raw.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Dough

01 ACTIVATE THE YEAST

Combine warm milk, sugar, and yeast in a small bowl, letting it sit 8–10 minutes until foamy.

02 MIX AND KNEAD

Combine flour and salt, then add the yeast mixture, yogurt, oil, and warm water. Mix to a shaggy dough and knead 8–10 minutes until smooth and soft.

03 LET IT RISE

Place in an oiled bowl, cover, and let rise in a warm spot for 1–1.5 hours until doubled in size.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Dough, continued



COOKING CHECKPOINT

The dough is ready when it has doubled and a gentle finger poke leaves a slow-springing indent.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Topping & Cooking

04 DIVIDE AND SHAPE

Punch down the dough, divide into 6 balls, and roll or hand-stretch each into an oval about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 PRESS ON THE GARLIC TOPPING

Mix the minced garlic and coriander together. Press a generous spoonful onto the surface of each rolled naan, using the rolling pin to gently press it into the dough so it doesn't fall off during cooking.



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Topping & Cooking, continued

06 COOK TOPPING-SIDE UP

Wet the underside of the naan and press onto a very hot tava, topping-side facing up. Cover with a lid briefly to help the top cook through, then flip carefully to lightly char the garlic side for the last 30 seconds.

Color indicator. the garlic should turn golden and fragrant, not dark brown — pull the naan the moment you see light charring.

07 BASTE AND SERVE

Brush with the melted butter or ghee immediately off the heat, adding a pinch of chili flakes if using. Serve immediately while the garlic is still fragrant.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Cooking the garlic side down first, directly against the hottest part of the pan, is the most common cause of burnt, bitter garlic. Always start topping-side up and only briefly flip to finish.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot, torn by hand, alongside rich, creamy curries that benefit from garlic's sharpness.

Restaurant Presentation

- Served whole in a bread basket, garlic and coriander flecks visible, often with an extra butter brush right before it reaches the table.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A shared basket alongside plain and butter naan, so the table can choose their favorite.

Modern Pairing

- Excellent as a standalone appetizer with a yogurt-mint dip, beyond its traditional role as a curry accompaniment.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Garlic Right

- Mince garlic finely and evenly — large chunks burn while smaller pieces roast evenly and turn sweet.
- A touch of butter mixed directly into the garlic-coriander topping helps it adhere and roast more evenly.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Dough can rise overnight in the refrigerator; mince the garlic topping fresh the next day for best flavor.
- Naan freezes well after cooking — reheat on a hot tava rather than defrosting in a microwave, which can make the garlic topping soggy.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some restaurants roast the garlic lightly in butter before topping the naan, which mellows its sharpness into a sweeter, more mellow flavor — try this if you prefer a gentler garlic taste.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

270 kcal	7 g	43 g	8 g	1.5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Garlic Butter Naan	an even richer version with extra butter worked into both the dough and the final baste.
Garlic Cheese Naan	stuffed with shredded cheese in addition to the garlic topping, a popular modern fusion.
Spicy Garlic Naan	extra chili flakes and a pinch of chaat masala for heat and tang.

Why did my garlic turn bitter?

Almost always overcooking — garlic burns quickly at high heat. Cook topping-side up first and only briefly finish it directly on the heat.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make this without yeast?

Yes, using a baking powder and baking soda quick-dough method, though the texture will be slightly denser.

Can I prep the garlic topping in advance?

It's best minced fresh, but you can prepare it up to 2 hours ahead, covered, at room temperature.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Tandoor	a traditional clay oven capable of very high, dry heat.
Dhania	Hindi for fresh coriander (cilantro), used generously in the garlic topping.
Maida	refined white flour, the traditional base for naan dough.
Lehsun	Hindi for garlic.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Garlic Naan

20m ACTIVE PREP	**1.5h** DOUGH RISE
20m COOK TIME	**6** SERVINGS (6 NAANS)
Med DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

All-purpose flour	375 g
Instant yeast	3 g
Sugar	4 g
Plain yogurt	45 g
Milk	120 ml
Water	60 ml
Oil	30 ml
Salt	6 g

GARLIC TOPPING

Garlic	25 g
Fresh coriander	12 g
Butter or ghee	45 g
Red chili flakes — optional	1 g

METHOD

01 **Activate the yeast.** Combine warm milk, sugar, and yeast in a small bowl, letting it sit 8–10 minutes until foamy.

02 **Mix and knead.** Combine flour and salt, then add the yeast mixture, yogurt, oil, and warm water.

03 **Let it rise.** Place in an oiled bowl, cover, and let rise in a warm spot for 1–1.5 hours until doubled in size.

04 **Divide and shape.** Punch down the dough, divide into 6 balls, and roll or hand-stretch each into an oval about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 **Press on the garlic topping.** Mix the minced garlic and coriander together.

06 **Cook topping-side up.** Wet the underside of the naan and press onto a very hot tava, topping-side facing up.

07 **Baste and serve.** Brush with the melted butter or ghee immediately off the heat, adding a pinch of chili flakes if using.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ All-purpose flour	375 g	☐ Instant yeast	3 g
☐ Sugar	4 g	☐ Plain yogurt	45 g
☐ Milk	120 ml	☐ Oil	30 ml
☐ Salt	6 g	☐ Garlic	25 g
☐ Fresh coriander	12 g	☐ Butter or ghee	45 g
☐ Red chili flakes — optional	1 g		

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com